

Ancient Egypt

Around 3000 BCE, the people who lived along the Nile River created one of the world's earliest civilizations, ancient Egypt. Kings known as pharaohs ruled Egypt for over 3,000 years. It was the most stable and longest-lasting civilization in the ancient world.

Fertile Nile

Egypt lies along the Nile River, which flows through the desert of northeast Africa into the Mediterranean Sea.



The Sphinx, a statue of a lion with a human head, guards the pyramids.

Sphinx at Giza

Giza

Memphis

Plowing

Farmers grew wheat and other crops next to the river.

Sailing south

Egyptian boats sailed south using the wind, which usually blows from north to south. The current carried them north again.

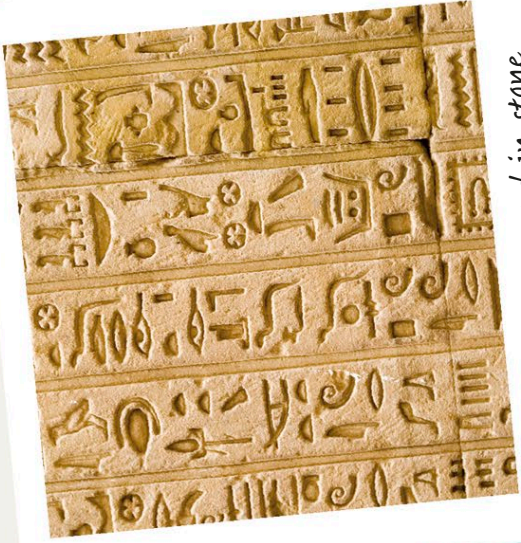
Pyramids of Giza

From 2650 to 1800 BCE, pharaohs were buried in huge stone tombs called pyramids. The Great Pyramid is the only survivor of the seven wonders of the ancient world.



Hieroglyphs

The Egyptians invented hieroglyphs, the world's first writing system. Hieroglyphs were pictures that stood for things and ideas. They were carved in stone or written on a type of paper called papyrus.



Hieroglyphs carved in stone

KEY (3000 - 1000 BCE)

Egyptian border
The dotted line shows the edge of Egypt.

Wheat

This was the main crop grown along the Nile.

Mud houses

People lived in houses made of mud bricks.

SCALE

0 250 miles

0 250 kilometers

LOWER EGYPT